



LAKEWOOD CITY COUNCIL MINUTES

Monday, March 2, 2026

City of Lakewood

6000 Main Street SW

Lakewood, WA 98499

<https://us02web.zoom.us/j/86872632373>

Dial +1(253) 215- 8782 Participant ID: 868 7263 2373

CALL TO ORDER

Mayor Bocchi called the meeting to order at 7:00 p.m.

ROLL CALL

Councilmembers Present: 6 – Mayor Paul Bocchi, Deputy Mayor Patti Belle, Councilmembers Ellen Talbo, Philip Lindholm, Ryan Pearson and J. Trestin Lauricella.

Councilmember Excused: 1 – Councilmember Michael Brandstetter.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

Mayor Bocchi paused for a moment of silence and led the Pledge of Allegiance.

PROCLAMATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS

Proclamation recognizing March, 2026 as American Red Cross Month.

COUNCILMEMBER LINDHOLM PRESENTED A PROCLAMATION RECOGNIZING MARCH, 2026 AS AMERICAN RED CROSS MONTH TO LARRY BLEICH, COMMUNITY LEADER, AMERICAN RED CROSS – SOUTH PUGET SOUND AND OLYMPICS CHAPTER.

Youth Council Report.

Youth Councilmember Danielle DeJesus shared that in February students created Valentines cards for residents, presented to the Lakewood Rotary Club and volunteered at the Lakewood First Lions Crab Feed.

Youth Councilmember Naela Collins shared that students will be volunteering at various events throughout the community and she spoke about the need for individuals to participate in Skills Stations at the Youth Summit on April 18th.

Clover Park School District Report.

Janet Caldwell, Boardmember, Clover Park School District (CPSD) shared that due to budget uncertainty there is a proposal to eliminate four positions, the graduation rate is 93.7% and she spoke about educational programming to strengthen student achievement. She reported that the STEAM Fair will be held on March 7th from 9 a.m. to 1 p.m. at Harrison Preparatory School, March 9-13th is Classified Employees Week, on March 11th the CPSD Board will hold a Budget Workshop and there will be a Financial Aid Night on April 15th. She then recognized students who received Thesby Awards and participated in a College and Career Summit in February.

PUBLIC COMMENTS

Paul Brice, Lakewood resident, spoke in support of allowing retail cannabis in the City.

Sharlynn Gates, Lakewood resident, expressed appreciation for the Lakewood Police Department Officers who responded to an incident last weekend in her neighborhood.

Haley Ivey, Lakewood resident, spoke in support of valuing and preserving natural vegetation and wildlife at the Seeley Lake trailhead and the protection of the Chambers Creek Watershed.

Christina Manetti, Lakewood resident, expressed concerns about the new permit portal due to lack of timely document accessibility.

Christina Manetti, Garry Oak Coalition, spoke about the loss of critical areas and Garry Oak trees throughout the city.

Ebrahim Mirjalili, Lakewood resident, spoke about the payroll check approval and the city's land surveyor.

Mark Herr, Lakewood resident, spoke about expanding his business operations into Pierce County and continuing to enhance the city's relationship with the Lakewood Chamber of Commerce.

John Burns, Lakewood resident, spoke in support of fiscal responsibility and increased communication from the city.

James Dunlop, Lakewood resident, spoke in support of the protection and maintenance of the natural environment and Garry Oak trees at all stages of their life cycle.

C O N S E N T A G E N D A

- A. Approval of the minutes of the City Council study session of February 9, 2026.
- B. Approval of the minutes of the City Council meeting of February 17, 2026.
- C. Approval of claims vouchers, in the amount of \$3,746,613.02, for the period of January 16, 2026 through February 13, 2026.
- D. Approval of payroll checks, in the amount of \$3,181,225.22, for the period of January 16, 2026 through February 15, 2026.

- E. Motion No. 2026-17

Authorizing the execution of an agreement with CivilAir Engineers, PLLC, in the amount of \$950,000, for Downtown Subarea Transportation Feasibility Study.

- F. Motion No. 2026-18

Authorizing the execution of an agreement with Pacific Rim Talent, in the amount of \$52,350, for special event entertainment.

- G. Motion No. 2026-19

Authorizing the execution of an agreement with Cascade Right of Way Services, in the amount of \$79,835, for real estate negotiation services related to the Mt. Tacoma – Interlaaken to Whitman Project.

- H. Motion No. 2026-20

Authorizing the award of a construction contract to R.L. Alia Co., in the amount of \$1,780,137, for the Custer Road – Bridgeport to 75th Project.

- I. Items filed in the Office of the City Clerk:

- 1. Lakewood's Promise Advisory Board meeting minutes of January 8, 2026.
 - 2. Planning Commission meeting minutes of January 21, 2026.
 - 3. Parks and Recreation Advisory Board meeting minutes of January 27, 2026.

Councilmember Talbo requested Item No. E, Motion No. 2026-17 be removed from the Consent Agenda.

MAYOR BOCCHI MOVED TO ADOPT THE CONSENT AGENDA, MINUS ITEM NO. E, MOTION NO. 2026-17. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

COUNCILMEMBER TALBO MOVED TO ADOPT ITEM NO. E, MOTION NO. 2026-17. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER LAURICELLA. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

R E G U L A R A G E N D A

ORDINANCE

Ordinance No. 846 Amending engineering development regulations, including the Engineering Standards Manual, Lakewood Municipal Code (LMC) Titles 12 and 13, and Chapter 18A.20.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT ORDINANCE NO. 846. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER LINDHOLM. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None.

NEW BUSINESS

None.

REPORTS BY THE CITY MANAGER

City Manager Russell shared that a review of the Lakewood Station Kendrick Street project 30% design and review of an Ordinance related to the one tenth of one percent sales tax for public defense will come forward at the March 9th Council meeting.

He announced the following upcoming meetings and events:

- March 5, 6 P.M., Oakbrook Neighborhood Meeting, Oakbrook Elementary

- March 6, 5:30 P.M., Clover Park Rotary Invitational, McGavick Conference Center
- March 10, 6:30 P.M., Tillicum Neighborhood, Tillicum Community Center
- March 11, 7 P.M., Lake City Neighborhood Association Meeting, Lake City Fire Station

CITY COUNCIL COMMENTS

Councilmember Lauricella shared that last week he attended the Community Services Advisory Board meeting. He recognized the work that has been completed on the Nyanza Road improvement project and shared that he will attend the STEAM Fair.

Councilmember Talbo shared that she attended the Asia Pacific Cultural Center New Year Celebration, the Fort Steilacoom Neighborhood Association meeting and she complimented the work on the Interlaaken Drive improvement project. She shared that this weekend she will attend the Lakewood Multicultural Coalition Gala.

Councilmember Pearson shared that last week he attended meetings with the State Legislative Delegation in Olympia, the Downtown Neighborhood Association meeting, Puget Sound Regional Council and the Parks and Recreation Advisory Board meeting.

Councilmember Lindholm shared that last week he attended the Community Services Advisory Board meeting and the American 250 food donation event. He shared that this week he will attend the Lakewood Rotary Invitational, South Sound Housing Affordability Partnership (SHAA³P) meeting and the Lakewood Multicultural Coalition Gala.

Deputy Mayor Belle thanked those who provided comments this evening and the Youth Council for their work on coordinating the Youth Summit. She shared that she will attend the Lakewood Multicultural Coalition Gala and congratulated the Clover Park High School Timberwolf Basketball Team for their season.

Mayor Bocchi spoke about meetings he attended with the State Legislative Delegation and Congresswoman Strickland as well the Chief Leschi Honor Walk.

At 8:30 p.m., Mayor Bocchi, announced that the City Council will recess into Executive Session for approximately 15 minutes pursuant to RCW 42.30.110(1)(i) to discuss with legal counsel representing the agency litigation or potential litigation to which the agency, the governing body, or a member acting in an official capacity is, or is likely to become, a party, when public knowledge regarding the discussion is likely to result in an adverse legal or financial consequence to the agency. The City Council is not expected to take action following the Executive Session other than to adjourn the meeting. Present for the Executive Session: Mayor Bocchi, Deputy Mayor Belle, Councilmembers Talbo, Lindholm, Pearson, Lauricella, City Manager Russell, City Attorney Wachter and Planning, Public Works Director Jeff Rimack and Assistant Director Angie Silva.

The City Council recessed at 8:30 p.m. At 8:45 p.m., Mayor Bocchi announced that the Executive Session will be extended for an additional 10 minutes. At 8:55 p.m., Mayor Bocchi announced that the Executive Session will be extended for an additional five minutes. The City Council reconvened at 9:00 p.m.

ADJOURNMENT

There being no further business, the meeting adjourned at 9:00 p.m.



PAUL BOCCHI, MAYOR

ATTEST:



BRIANA SCHUMACHER
CITY CLERK